Written Homework Assignment #4

The dictionary definition for **ART** is:

> The conscious use of the imagination in the production of objects intended to be contemplated or appreciated as beautiful, as in the arrangement of forms, sounds, or words.

In contrast, the dictionary definition for **CRAFT** is:

> Skill in doing or making something, as in the arts; proficiency..

Your task for this assignment is to pick one of the works shown, then look at it carefully and decide if, *IN YOUR OPINION*, it represents **ART** or **CRAFT**. Write a paragraph that describes your thinking on the piece that answers the following nine questions:

- Is this piece ART or CRAFT? Is it perhaps BOTH?
    - This piece is both art and craft. Craft is representative in their understanding of color theory and drawing skills which are clearly demonstrated. It is also art since the artist was able to symbolically show the joy that imagined subjects in the painting found despite their bleak and painful reality.
- What about this selection drew you to it or caught your eye?
    - The color of this painting first drew us in, however as we took a closer look we saw the women dancing to the beat of the drums. Knowing the context and time period of these paintings, we appreciated the significance of finding joy in music.
- What kinds of *feelings* does the piece elicit when you see it?

    - Despite the darkness around the painting, we can see the hope and faith seeping through the contrast of the lighter colors surrounding the dancers and sky.
- What do you think the artist is trying to say with the piece?
    - The artist is showing the joy that could still be experienced in some of the darkest times in American history. That hope is what kept so many going when everything pointed to giving up.
- What does the piece say to YOU personally regardless of what the artist is saying?
    - This piece signifies that you can always find joy regardless of the situation you are in. While we have made milestones, there are many things we as a society need to improve on. However, just like this painting we can have joy in the darkness.
- Do you think Artificial Intelligence could produce something of equal meaning?
    - I think that it may be able to replicate pieces like this, but there would be no personal connection or deeper meaning that could be derived from the piece. In all honesty, it would likely detract from the deeper connection that the subject could make with the piece and story being shared.
- How do you think you might apply the concept of art or craft to your software designs and coding?
    - In my Finance Buddy app, I'm not just concerned with functionality, but with helping users feel supported and not overwhelmed. After getting something to work, I also go back to refine and simplify my code, which is where craft starts to feel like art. Overall, craft makes a product functional, but art is what makes people want to use it.
- Do you think software creation SHOULD BE an art? Should it be a craft?
    - I think it should be craft first and foremost. This guarantees that the structure and design of the system is in place. It could also be considered art if there is a second step of intentionality that transcends simple functionality. It should be well written, easy to read, elegant, and implemented in the most simple way possible.

- What kinds of questions do you ask yourself about your design/code? Do you go back to it after it is working and re-factor it to make it *clean*?

- When I'm designing or writing code, I try to go beyond just making it work. I ask myself questions like: "Is this actually solving a real problem?", "Would someone else understand this without me explaining it?", and "Am I overcomplicating this?" I also think about the user side, "Does this feel intuitive, or would it confuse someone?" Once the code is working, I do go back and refactor it to make it cleaner. I'll simplify logic, improve naming, and restructure anything that feels messy or hard to follow. For me, getting it to work is just the first step—making it clear, maintainable, and easy to use is just as important.

THERE ARE NO WRONG ANSWERS HERE. This is an opinion piece which is intended to get you thinking about YOUR software efforts and how engaged you are with your products, beyond simply making it work.